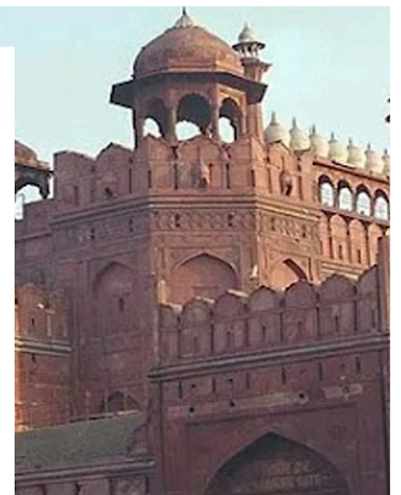
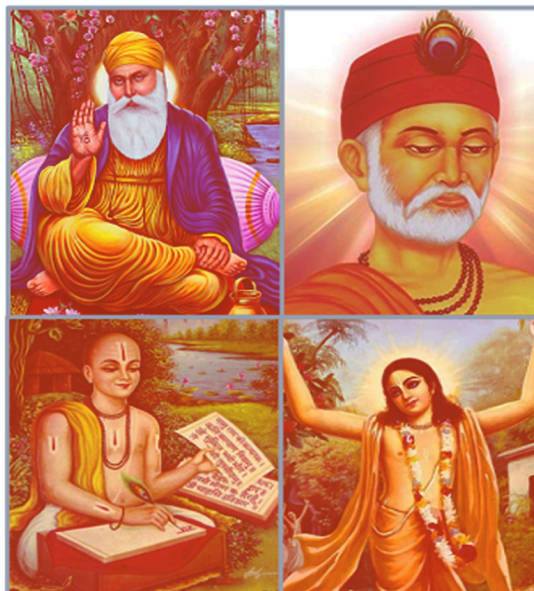
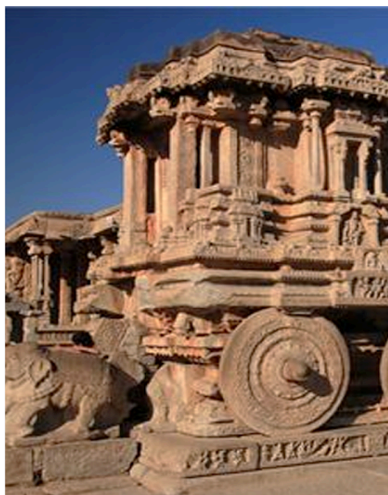


General Knowledge

Medieval History

STUDY NOTES

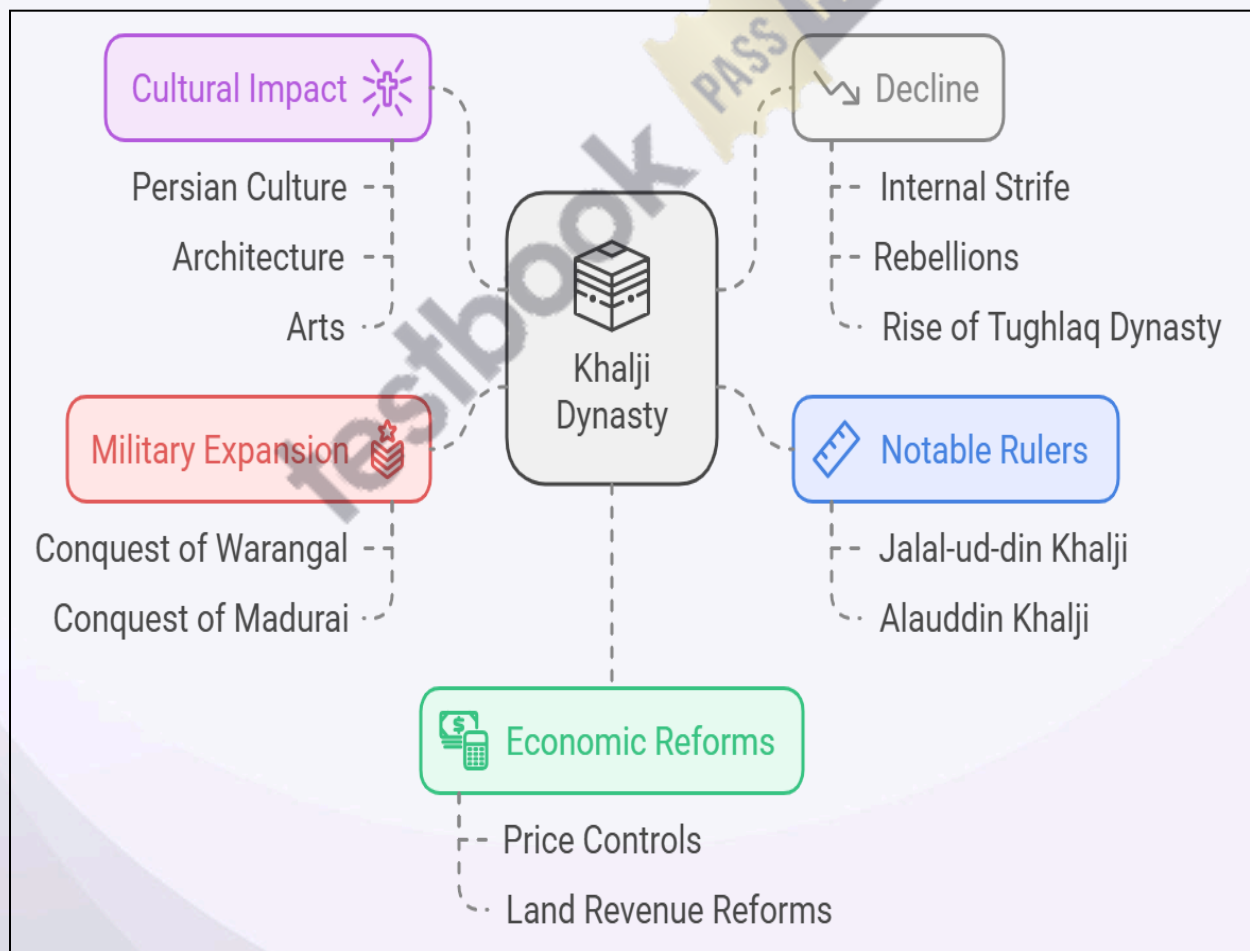
Khalji Dynasty(1290-1320)



The Khalji Dynasty was founded in **1290** by **Jalal-ud-din Khalji** after he overthrew the last ruler of the **Slave Dynasty**, marking the beginning of a new era in the Delhi Sultanate.

Notable rulers include **Alauddin Khalji**, who reigned from **1296** to **1316** and is famous for his military conquests and administrative reforms.

- **Military Expansion:** The dynasty is known for its military campaigns in South India, including the conquest of **Warangal** and **Madurai**, significantly expanding the territory of the Delhi Sultanate.
- **Economic Reforms:** Alauddin Khalji implemented significant economic policies, including price controls on essential commodities and land revenue reforms, which helped stabilize the economy.
- **Cultural Impact:** The Khalji Dynasty is credited with promoting **Persian culture**, architecture, and the arts, contributing to the rich cultural tapestry of medieval India.
- **Decline:** The dynasty began to decline after the death of Alauddin Khalji, facing internal strife, rebellions, and the eventual rise of the Tughlaq Dynasty in the early **14th century**.



Overview of Khalji Dynasty:

Ruler	Reign Time	Contributions
Jalal-ud-din Khalji	1290-1296	Founder of the Khalji Dynasty; established central authority.
Alauddin Khalji	1296-1316	Expanded the empire; implemented economic reforms; known for military conquests in South India.
Shihab-ud-din Umar	1316	His reign was marked by instability and internal strife.
Mubarak Shah Khalji	1316 -1320	Attempted to restore the glory of the dynasty but faced challenges.
Khusaran Khan	1320 -1320	The last ruler of the Khalji Dynasty; faced invasions and rebellions.

Jalaluddin Khalji (1290 to 1296)

- **Jalal-ud-din Khalji founded** the Khalji Dynasty and ascended the throne in **1290** after overthrowing the last ruler of the **Slave Dynasty**.
- His reign lasted from **1290** to **1296**, and he worked to consolidate his power and stabilize the empire.
- He undertook several military campaigns, notably against the **Mongols**, showcasing his strategic military capabilities.
- His reign marked the beginning of aggressive expansionism in the **Delhi Sultanate**.
- Jalal-ud-din is credited with establishing a centralized administrative system that laid the groundwork for his successors, promoting merit-based appointments.

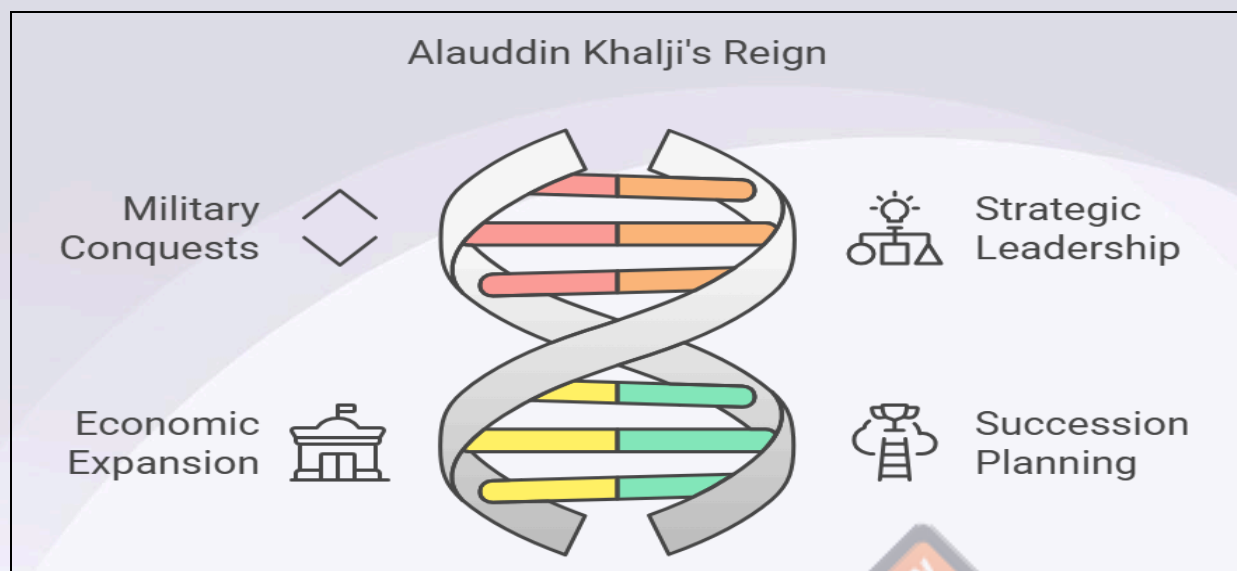
- Unlike some of his successors, he was known for his relatively tolerant policies towards Hindus and other communities, promoting unity within his realm.
- Jalal-ud-din Khalji established his capital at **Kilokhri**, where he governed for almost six years.
- His reign ended abruptly when he was assassinated in **1296** by his ambitious nephew, Alauddin Khalji, who subsequently succeeded him.
- The most notable event of Jalaluddin Khalji's reign was the **invasion of Devagiri** by his nephew and son-in-law, Alauddin Khalji.

Alauddin Khalji (1296 to 1316)

- **Alauddin Khalji** ascended to the throne by assassinating his uncle and father-in-law, Jalaluddin Khalji, in **1296**.

Military Conquests

- **Gujarat:** Raided in 1299 and annexed in 1304.
- **Ranthambore:** Captured in 1301.
- **Chittor:** Conquered in 1303.
- **Malwa:** Annexed in 1305.
- **Siwana:** Taken in 1308.
- **Jalore:** Secured in 1311.
- His slave-general **Malik Kafur** led multiple campaigns to the south of the Vindhyas, obtaining a considerable amount of wealth from **Devagiri (1308)**, **Warangal (1310)**, and **Dwarasamudra(1311)**
- Alauddin Khalji, through his general **Malik Kafur**, conducted military raids into the Pandyan Kingdom in the deep south, further expanding his empire's reach and influence
- Alauddin died in **1316**. He was succeeded by his minor son with the help of Malik Kafur.



Expansion and consolidation of the Empire:

Alauddin's campaigns for the expansion of the empire

Expansion in North India

- **Ranthambore (1301):** Captured to assert dominance over Rajput territories.
- **Chittor (1303):** Significant victory symbolizing control over Rajputana.
- **Malwa (1305):** Annexed for its strategic and economic importance.
- **Gujarat (1299-1304):** Raided and annexed, adding wealth through trade.
- **Siwana and Jalore (1308, 1311):** Secured these regions to eliminate threats from rival clans.
- **Mongol Defense:** Successfully repelled Mongol invasions, enhancing his military reputation.



Expansion of empire in South India (Under Malik Kafur)

Devagiri (1306-07)

- The **Yadav dynasty** ruled it during this time under the **king Ramdev**.
- The kingdom of Devagiri was attacked when Ramdev refused to pay the yearly tax to Alauddin.
- Ramdev was brought to Delhi, where he later surrendered.

Warangal/ Telangana (1308)

- The **Kakatiya dynasty** was ruling here under the ruler **Pratap Rudra Dev**.
- His kingdom was immensely rich, which eventually became a reason for Alauddin's attack.
- He accepted Alauddin's rule and **gifted him the Kohinoor diamond**.

Dwar Samudra (1310)

- It was geographically located on the **west coast of the state of Karnataka**.
- It was ruled by the **Hoysala dynasty** under **Ballal III**.

Madurai (1311)

- The **Pandya dynasty** ruled it under **Vir and Sundar Pandya**.
- Vir Pandya and Sundar Pandya developed a conflict.
- During this course, Sundar Pandya asked for help from Alauddin.
- Sundar Pandya and Alauddin together defeated Vir Pandya.
- Sundar Pandya, in turn, accepted Alauddin's rule.



Administrative reforms

- **Free grants** of lands for religious purposes
- Prohibited the use of **wine and intoxicants**
- **Reorganization** of the spy system
- Nobles should not have social gatherings and marriage alliances without the permission of the Sultan.

Market Reforms

- Alauddin wanted to maintain a large army; he, therefore, lowered and fixed the price of the commodities of daily use.
- To control the prices, Alauddin set up three different markets for different commodities in Delhi: grain market (**Mandi**), cloth market (**Sarai Adl**) and the market for horses, slaves, cattle, etc.
- To ensure implementation, Alauddin appointed a superintendent (Shahna-i-Mandi) who was assisted by an intelligence officer.
- Alauddin received daily reports of the market from **Barid** (intelligence officer) and **munhiyans** (secret spies).
- **Diwan-i-Riyasat**, a separate department, was established under the command of Naib-i-Riyasat. Every merchant was registered with the Market Department.
- Low prices in the horse market were ensured by putting a stop to the purchase of horses by horse dealers and brokers (**dalals**) in the Delhi market.

Military Reforms

- Alauddin was the first Sultan to establish a **large permanent standing army**, which he paid for with cash from the royal treasury.
- He established an innovative **Chehra and Dagh System**, in which the Chehra (**full description of each soldier**) and Dagh (**Horse branding**) were preserved.

Social reforms

- He **banned prostitution** in Delhi, ordering all prostitutes to be married.
- Male adulterers were castrated, and female adulterers were stoned to death.
- Alauddin also took action against charlatans and sorcerers, banning their activities.

Books and Authors:

Author	Book	Period	Details
Amir Khusrau	Tughlaq Nama	Alauddin Khilji's Court	Historical narrative of the period.
	Khazain-ul-Futu		Describes the military victories of Alauddin Khilji.
	Diwan (Collection of Poetry)		A mix of Persian and Hindavi poetry.
Ziauddin Barani	Tarikh-i-Firoz Shahi	Later Khilji Dynasty Period	A historical account covering the Khilji and Tughlaq dynasties.

Architecture During the Khalji Dynasty



Alai Darwaza

- Alai Darwaza is the main entrance to the Qutub Minar complex in Delhi.
- Built-in **1311** by **Alauddin Khilji**, it is a key example of early **Indo-Islamic** architecture.
- It was the first in India to feature true **Islamic arches** and **domes**.
- Made of red sandstone with white marble inlay, it showcases intricate carvings and calligraphy.



Jamat khana

- Jamat Khana Masjid was built by Khwaja Jahan during the reign of Alauddin Khilji in the 14th century.
- It is situated within the **Nizamuddin Auliya Dargah complex** in Delhi.
- The mosque showcases a blend of Tughlaq architecture with a simple yet elegant design, including red sandstone construction.
- It serves as a place for congregational prayers and holds spiritual significance for followers of **Hazrat Nizamuddin Auliya**.



Siri Fort

- **Built by Alauddin Khilji in the early 14th century**, Siri Fort was the second of the seven cities of medieval Delhi and served as a key defence structure during Khilji's rule.
- The fort was made using rubble masonry and had thick walls with high bastions, representing the strength of Tughlaq-era fortifications.
- Only remnants of the fort remain today, with some portions integrated into modern areas like Siri Fort Auditorium and sports complexes in South Delhi.



Thousand Pillars Mahal

- **Thousand Pillars Mahal** is in the Warangal Fort, Telangana, built by the Kakatiya dynasty.
- Famous for its intricately carved pillars, symbolizing grandeur.
- It served as a royal court, showcasing Kakatiya architectural excellence.

Shihab-ud-din Omar (1316)

- Shihab-ud-din Omar was the son of Alauddin Khalji and succeeded him briefly after he died in **1316**.
- During Omar's brief reign, **Malik Kafur**, Alauddin's trusted general, acted as the regent, holding actual power.
- Kafur attempted to control the empire by installing Shihab-ud-din as a puppet ruler.
- Shihab-ud-din's reign was short-lived, lasting only a few months, as Malik Kafur was soon assassinated.
- Afterward, Shihab-ud-din was **deposed by Qutb-ud-din Mubarak Shah**, another of Alauddin's sons, who took over the throne.

Qutb-ud-din Mubarak (1316 to 1320)

- **Qutb-ud-din Mubarak Shah** was a member of the Khalji Dynasty and the son of Alauddin Khalji.
- After **Alauddin's death**, Malik Kafur imprisoned **Mubarak Shah** and his younger brother, Shihab-ud-din Omar, to maintain control of the empire.
- However, after Kafur's assassination, Mubarak removed Shihab-ud-din from power and proclaimed himself Sultan of Delhi
- Upon becoming Sultan, Mubarak sought to win popular support by abolishing the heavy taxes and penalties imposed by his father. He also released thousands of prisoners, presenting himself as a more lenient and benevolent ruler.
- Despite his initial popularity, Mubarak Shah's reign ended in 1320 when he was murdered as part of a conspiracy led by his slave general Khusrau Khan, who then took the throne.

Khusaran Khan (1320 to 1320)

- **Khusrau Khan** was the Sultan of Delhi for around two months in **1320**.
- Khusrau Khan led a successful campaign to reassert Delhi's control over **Devagiri** in **1317**.
- He assassinated **Mubarak Khan** and ascended the throne with the regnal name Nasiruddin.
- He was soon deposed by a group of rebels led by the noble **Malik Tughluq**, who succeeded him on the throne.
- According to the Delhi chronicler **Amir Khusrau**, Khusrau Khan and his brother belonged to a Hindu military caste or group called Baradu.

Decline of the Khilji Dynasty:

- After the death of Alauddin in AD 1316, Malik Kafur sat on the throne for a few days, only to be deposed by Qutbuddin Mubarak Shah.
- During this period, rebellions broke out in Deogir but were harshly suppressed.
- **Qutbuddin Mubarak Shah** was soon murdered, and Khusrau ascended the throne. However, he, too, did not last long as some dissatisfied officers, led by Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq, defeated and killed him in a battle.
- Thus, only four years after the death of Alauddin, the **Khalji dynasty** came to an end, and power passed into the hands of the Tughlaqs.